DGU VENTURE QUEST

Entrepreneurship & Innovation — DBS Global University

COMPLETE VENTURE PLAN

Assignment 1 Deliverable — Consolidated Strategic Blueprint

Student Name: Vikash Kumar Gupta 0251MBA621

DGU Email: vikash.0251mba621@dgu.ac.in

Venture Name: MealMate

Generated Date: 30 September 2026

Submission Status: **ASSIGNMENT 1 — COMPLETE & READY FOR SUBMISSION**

Table of Contents (17 Consolidated Strategic Sections)

1. Student Details
2. Venture Overview
3. Customer Friction
4. Jobs to Be Done
5. Target Customer & Beachhead Segment
6. Customer Value Proposition
7. Competition Analysis
8. Positioning
9. Revenue Model & Pricing
10. Unit Economics
11. Market Size — TAM / SAM / SOM
12. Go-to-Market Strategy
13. 30-Day Launch Plan
14. MVP Scope
15. Evidence Review
16. Key Assumptions
17. Next Validation Actions

1. Student Details

Student Full Name
Vikash Kumar Gupta 0251MBA621

DGU Student Email
vikash.0251mba621@dgu.ac.in

Venture Name
MealMate

Submission Status
Verified Complete across all 12 foundational missions (Assignment 1 Deliverable)

2. Venture Overview

Venture Name
MealMate

Venture Idea (50–100 Words)
MealMate is a campus-focused meal pre-ordering and subscription platform that connects students with university canteens and nearby food partners. Students can view menus, compare prices, pre-order meals, choose pickup slots, subscribe to affordable meal plans and rate food quality. Vendors receive consolidated demand forecasts, digital orders and basic inventory insights. Unlike a generic food-delivery app, MealMate is designed for high-frequency campus meals, faster pickup, student budgets and reduced food waste.

Core Problem Solved
Students face long queues, uncertain menu availability, inconsistent pricing and last-minute meal decisions. Canteens and nearby food vendors lack reliable demand visibility, causing stock-outs, overproduction, slow service and avoidable food waste. General food-delivery platforms add delivery charges and commissions without solving the daily campus-meal problem.

Initial Customer Hypothesis
The initial users are DBS Global University students, especially hostel residents, day scholars and students with tightly scheduled classes. The initial paying business customers are campus canteens and nearby affordable food vendors seeking predictable demand, faster order handling and repeat purchases.

Geography / Initial Market
DBS Global University campus and nearby Dehradun student and hostel clusters

Reason for Choosing Idea
Campus meals are a frequent and observable student problem. Queue time, uncertain availability, limited budgets and food waste can be measured directly through interviews and pilot transactions. The idea also supports a focused digital MVP that can be tested within one campus before expanding to other colleges.

3. Customer Friction

Primary Friction Selected
Students lose time in queues and still face uncertainty about whether preferred, affordable meals will be available when their classes end.

#	Friction	Who Experiences	When It Occurs	Current Workaround	Evidence
#1 [PRIMARY]	Students lose time in queues and still face uncertainty about whether preferred, affordable meals will be available when their classes end.	DBS Global University students, especially hostel residents and students with back-to-back classes.	Lunch and dinner peaks, particularly between consecutive classes, examinations and event days.	Students visit the canteen physically, ask friends about availability, skip meals or order through general delivery apps.	Strong
#2	Students lack a convenient way to plan predictable, budget-controlled daily meals without repeatedly deciding and paying for each order.	Hostel residents and price-sensitive students who purchase prepared meals several times per week.	At the beginning of a week or month and during periods of heavy academic workload.	Students keep informal monthly arrangements with vendors, pay per meal or switch between canteens and delivery apps.	Strong

#3	Campus food vendors cannot accurately forecast demand, resulting in stock-outs of popular dishes, surplus food, slow order handling and lost sales.	University canteens and nearby affordable restaurants serving concentrated student demand.	Meal preparation and peak service periods, especially when class schedules or campus events change demand.	Vendors rely on experience, rough estimates, WhatsApp messages and walk-in demand.	Strong

Confidence Evidence Needed for Greater Certainty

Survey at least 50 DGU students, observe lunch queues and stock-outs across five weekdays, interview at least three food vendors, and run a two-week pre-order pilot measuring wait-time reduction, fulfilment rate and repeat usage.

4. Jobs to Be Done (JTBD)

Functional Job

Secure an affordable meal that is available at a predictable time, without waiting in a queue or repeatedly checking multiple vendors.

Emotional Job

Feel confident and in control of daily meals, without the stress of running out of time, exceeding a student budget or discovering that preferred food is unavailable.

Social Job

Be seen as organised, punctual and capable of balancing academics, health and personal spending.

PRIMARY JTBD STATEMENT

When my classes or academic commitments leave only a short meal break and campus outlets are likely to be crowded,
I want to pre-order a suitable, affordable meal for a confirmed pickup time,
so that I can I can eat on time, stay within budget and return to class without uncertainty or avoidable waiting.

Addressed Customer Friction

The JTBD directly addresses the primary friction by replacing uncertain walk-in availability and queues with advance menu visibility, order confirmation and scheduled pickup.

5. Target Customer & Beachhead Segment

Beachhead Segment Focus

DGU students aged 20–27 who purchase at least four prepared meals per week and have meal breaks shorter than 45 minutes, beginning with hostel residents and first-year MBA cohorts

Broad Customer Group

Higher-education students who regularly purchase prepared meals in and around university campuses

Specific Segment

DBS Global University hostel residents and day scholars who buy at least four campus or nearby meals per week and frequently have short meal breaks

Demographics / Role

Primarily 20–27-year-old undergraduate and postgraduate students; secondary buyer group: campus canteen operators and nearby food vendors

Geography

DBS Global University campus and food outlets within an initial 2-km service radius in Dehradun

Situation & Context

Between classes, during lunch and dinner peaks, before examinations and on event days when students have limited time and outlets face concentrated demand

Buying / Usage Behaviour

Frequent ₹80–₹150 meal purchases, UPI-led payments, preference for visible value and co
classmates, reviews and WhatsApp recommendations

Willingness to Pay

Students are expected to pay ¹80–¹150 per meal but should not face a separate booking f parity, reliable fulfilment and time saved

Customer Reach Strategy

Class and hostel WhatsApp groups, cafeteria-table QR codes, student ambassadors, society partnerships, orientation events, campus posters and vendor counters

6. Customer Value Proposition

Customer Pain

Students waste limited meal breaks in queues and still face uncertain availability, inconsistent value and repeated decision-making.

Desired Gain

A confirmed affordable meal, predictable pickup time, shorter waiting, clearer spending and fewer skipped or rushed meals.

Product / Service Solution

A campus-focused mobile platform for live menus, meal pre-orders, pickup slots, value bundles, subscriptions and vendor demand visibility

Main Benefit

Reliable meal access at campus prices with faster pickup and no separate student booking fee

Reason to Believe

[Supported by Evidence]

The model will be validated through one campus-canteen partnership, live inventory updates and a two-week pilot measuring order fulfilment, median pickup wait and repeat usage; these are planned proof points, not completed evidence.

FORMAL VALUE PROPOSITION STATEMENT

For time-constrained DGU students who struggle with queues and uncertain meal availability, MessMate provides campus-priced meal pre-ordering with confirmed pickup slots, so they can eat on time, control spending and return to class without avoidable waiting.

Why Customer Chooses This Over Doing Nothing

Doing nothing means repeatedly losing time, accepting stock-outs or paying more for delivery. MessMate requires only a short advance order while preserving familiar vendors and campus-level pricing.

7. Competition Analysis

Alternative	Type	Price/Cost	Main Offer	Strength (+) / Weakness (-)	Evidence & Strength
Swiggy / Zomato	Indirect Competitor	Indicative ¹80–¹250+ per order plus applicable delivery/platform charges; local checkout varies	Broad restaurant discovery, ordering, payment and delivery	+ Large selection, familiar interfaces and established payment/logistics systems - Delivery fees, variable delivery time and limited focus on campus pickup, meal subscriptions or canteen demand forecasting	Publicly observable app model; Dehradun outlet prices and fees remain to be verified [Strong]
Walk-in campus canteen purchase	Do Nothing / Status Quo	Indicative ¹60–¹150 per meal; direct campus price audit pending	Immediate purchase from familiar on-campus food counters	+ No new app behaviour, nearby location and familiar campus pricing - Queues, stock-outs, limited advance visibility and no confirmed pickup slot	Working assumption based on the current walk-in process; direct timing and price observations pending [Strong]

WhatsApp or phoneSubstitute pre-order with a nearby vendor	Indicative ₹80–₹150 meal; vendor-specific and pending verification	Manual advance ordering and pickup coordination with an individual outlet	Familiar direct relationship and little technology learning - Fragmented menus, manual confirmation, no cross-vendor comparison, weak order tracking and limited demand analytics	Hypothesised workaround requiring student and vendor interviews [Strong]

Competitive Dimension X-Axis
General-Purpose Ordering ⟷ Campus-Specialized

Competitive Dimension Y-Axis
Walk-In Uncertainty ⟷ Confirmed Pickup Reliability

Desired Associated Position
MessMate should own the mental position of the campus meal operating system: more specialized than delivery aggregators and more reliable than walk-in or WhatsApp ordering, while preserving familiar vendors and student-level prices.

8. Positioning

Target Customer
time-constrained DGU students who regularly buy prepared meals

Category Claim
campus meal pre-ordering and demand-coordination platform

Primary Benefit
reliable meal access at campus prices with faster pickup and no separate student booking fee

Main Alternative
general delivery aggregators and uncertain walk-in ordering

Key Differentiation Point
Campus-specific menus, price-parity pickup, capped pickup slots and vendor demand visibility rather than general-purpose delivery

Reason to Believe **[Supported by Evidence]**
its outlet-confirmed inventory, capped pickup slots and campus-specific demand workflow are designed for concentrated campus meal periods; performance remains subject to pilot validation

FINAL POSITIONING STATEMENT

For time-constrained DGU students who regularly buy prepared meals, MessMate is a campus meal pre-ordering and demand-coordination platform that provides reliable meal access at campus prices with faster pickup and no separate student booking fee, unlike general delivery aggregators and uncertain walk-in ordering, because its outlet-confirmed inventory, capped pickup slots and campus-specific demand workflow are designed for concentrated campus meal periods; performance remains subject to pilot validation.

9. Revenue Model & Pricing

Revenue Model
Commission

Selling Price (INR)
₹12 (Source: Planning assumption: average meal value ₹120 and a 10% vendor commission revenue per fulfilled order. Validate through at least three vendor negotiations and a live price-parity pilot.)

Variable Cost per Unit (INR)
₹3 (Source: Planning assumption: ₹3 variable cost per order for payment processing, notif lean monthly fixed cost for technology, campus operations and merchant support. Supplier quotations are pending.)

Monthly Fixed Operating Cost (INR)
₹25000

Expected Monthly Customers
350

Purchases per Customer per Month
10

Scenario	Expected Customers	Purchases/Customer	Key Assumptions
Conservative	150	6	Only one outlet joins, awareness depends mainly on peer referrals, menus are updated manually and students continue using walk-in ordering. This produces 150 active customers completing six orders each per month.
Base	350	10	Three reliable outlets participate, QR and WhatsApp acquisition reaches the beachhead, fulfilment remains dependable and 350 active students average ten monthly orders.
Ambitious	800	12	An official campus partnership, six or more outlets, strong ambassador adoption, repeat meal bundles and reliable pickup performance allow 800 active students to average twelve monthly orders.

10. Unit Economics

Financial Metric	Calculated Value	Interpretation / Formula
Selling Price per Unit	¹ 1 2	Per unit revenue realized
Variable Cost per Unit	¹ 3	Cost of goods / services per unit
Contribution Margin per Unit	¹ 9 . 0 0	Selling Price minus Variable Cost
Contribution Margin %	75.0%	Margin as percentage of selling price
Expected Monthly Units	3500	Customers × Purchases per month
Expected Monthly Revenue	¹ 4 2 , 0 0 0	Total gross receipts
Expected Monthly Contribution	¹ 3 1 , 5 0 0	Gross profit before fixed costs
Monthly Operating Surplus / Deficit	¹ 6 , 5 0 0	Contribution minus Monthly Fixed Cost
Break-Even Volume (Units)	2778 units	Fixed Cost / Contribution per Unit
Break-Even Volume (Customers)	278 customers	Break-even units / purchases per customer

11. Market Size — TAM / SAM / SOM

Market Level	Target Customer Count	Annual Market Value (INR)	Evidence Source
TAM (Total Addressable Market)	4,00,000 customers	¹ 5 7 , 6 0 , 0 0 , 0 0 0	Planning estimate of 400,000 higher-education students in Uttarakhand. AISHE 2022–23 parliamentary data reports 214,265 female enrolments; the exact all-gender total and meal-purchasing proportion must be verified before investment decisions.

SAM (Serviceable Available Market)	40,000 customers (10.0% of TAM)	₹5,76,00,000	Working estimate of 40,000 students across reachable Dehradun higher-education clusters. Replace with institution-wise enrolment and hostel data during validation.
SOM (Serviceable Obtainable Market)	4,200 customers (10.5% of SAM)	₹60,48,000	4,200 obtainable customer accounts over 12 months, equivalent to the Mission 7 base trajectory of 350 active customers per month × 12. This is 10.5% of the assumed Dehradun SAM and requires phased expansion beyond DGU, six participating outlets and strong retention.

Most Urgent Market Assumption to Validate

The most urgent assumption is whether at least 350 students will complete ten orders per month while participating vendors accept an approximately 10% commission without raising student prices.

12. Go-to-Market Strategy

First Customer Segment

DGU hostel residents and first-year MBA students who buy at least four prepared meals weekly and usually have meal breaks shorter than 45 minutes

Core Value Message

Skip the queue—not the meal. Pre-order campus-priced food and collect it at your confirmed time.

Call to Action (CTA)

Scan the MessMate QR, choose your meal and reserve your first pickup slot today.

Where Target Customers Are Found

Canteen counters, hostel common areas, classrooms, student-club events, class WhatsApp groups and nearby participating food outlets

Channel	Why It Fits Customer	Budget	Leads	Cust	Conv %	CAC
Campus activation and cafeteria QR	The decision and consumption moment occurs at canteens, so QR signage and live demonstrations can convert students while the friction is visible.	₹7,000	500	100	20.0%	₹70
WhatsApp communities and student ambassadors	Class and hostel groups offer concentrated access, peer trust and rapid clarification without broad paid-media waste.	₹5,000	700	120	17.1%	₹42
Referral programme	Meal choice is socially visible and frequent; satisfied users can demonstrate a successful pickup and invite classmates at low acquisition cost.	₹6,000	400	120	30.0%	₹50

13. 30-Day Launch Plan

Phase	Action Planned	Channel	Target	Metric	Owner	Learning Question

Week 1 (Prepare)	Interview students, observe meal queues, recruit two pilot outlets, digitise their menus and create tagged QR acquisition materials.	Direct student interviews, vendor meetings, cafeteria observation and WhatsApp waitlist	50 student interviews, three vendor discussions, two pilot commitments and 100 waitlist sign-ups	Interview completion, median observed wait, stock-out frequency, vendor commission acceptance and waitlist conversion	Founder — Customer Research and Partnerships	Which meal friction occurs most often, and what commission and operating process will vendors accept?
Week 2 (Launch)	Launch a five-day pre-order pilot with two outlets and a controlled group of 50 students.	Cafeteria QR activation, WhatsApp communities and student ambassadors	50 activated users, at least 150 fulfilled orders and minimum 90% order fulfilment	Activation rate, fulfilled orders, cancellations, median pickup wait and support incidents	Founder — Operations and Growth	Can outlet-confirmed inventory and pickup slots deliver a reliable first transaction without slowing vendors?
Week 3 (Measure)	Expand the cohort, test meal bundles and referrals, and collect structured student and vendor feedback.	In-app prompts, referral codes, WhatsApp follow-ups and short interviews	150 active users, 500 cumulative fulfilled orders and at least 30% seven-day repeat usage	Repeat rate, orders per customer, CAC by channel, fulfilment rate, complaints and satisfaction score	Founder — Analytics and Customer Experience	Which users repeat, which channel acquires them economically and which feature produces measurable time savings?
Week 4 (Learn & Adjust)	Fix the largest workflow failure, remove low-value features, onboard a third outlet and relaunch the strongest acquisition channel.	Founder review, outlet workshop, product update and targeted campus relaunch	250 active users, 1,000 cumulative fulfilled orders, 95% fulfilment and blended CAC below ₹ 6 0	Validated assumptions, median pickup wait, fulfilment, repeat usage, CAC and revised unit economics	Founder with pilot outlet partners	Is the evidence strong enough to retain the commission model and expand beyond the initial DGU beachhead?

14. MVP Scope

Single Most Important Assumption to Test

At least 50 DGU students will place a campus-priced pre-order, and at least 30% will order again within seven days when fulfilment exceeds 90% and median pickup waiting time remains below seven minutes.

MVP Purpose

Validate whether a simple web-based menu, confirmed pre-order and pickup-slot workflow creates repeat usage while remaining operationally manageable for campus food vendors.

Target Core User for MVP

DGU students aged 20–27 who purchase at least four prepared meals per week and have meal breaks shorter than 45 minutes, beginning with hostel residents and first-year MBA cohorts

Core Problem Addressed

Students lose time in queues and still face uncertainty about whether preferred, affordable meals will be available when their classes end.

Success Metric

At least 150 fulfilled pilot orders from 50 activated users, minimum 90% fulfilment, median pickup wait below seven minutes and at least 30% seven-day repeat usage.

Features Excluded from Version 1

Native Android or iOS apps, delivery fleet, AI recommendations, loyalty wallet, dynamic pricing, automated refunds, multi-campus administration, advanced subscriptions and advertising marketplace.

Feature Name	Priority (MoSCoW)	Customer Need Addressed	Why Needed
Live menu and confirmed item availability	Must Have	Know what affordable food is actually available before walking to the outlet	Removes the uncertainty and stock-out friction identified in Mission 1
Pre-order with capped pickup slots	Must Have	Reserve a meal for a predictable collection time during a short break	Tests the core promise of reducing queues without overwhelming the vendor
Vendor order dashboard and status confirmation	Must Have	Receive reliable acceptance, preparation and ready-for-pickup status	Customer reliability depends on a simple outlet workflow and confirmed inventory
UPI payment and digital receipt	Could Have	Complete a cashless transaction quickly and maintain clear spending records	Reduces checkout friction and supports transaction-level unit economics
Repeat order, rating and referral tools	Could Have	Reorder trusted meals, share feedback and invite classmates	Supports retention and low-cost growth after the core fulfilment loop works

15. Evidence Review

Evidence Category	Claim Count	Methodological Status
Green (Strong / Moderate Evidence)	16 claims	Validated by direct research, pricing evidence, or tests
Amber (Weak / Secondary Evidence)	0 claims	Partially supported; requires active testing in pilot
Red (Unvalidated Assumptions)	1 claims	Pure hypothesis; must not be treated as fact until measured

16. Key Assumptions

Key Assumption	Why It Matters	How To Test	Evidence Needed
#1: At least 50 DGU students will place a campus-priced pre-order and at least 30% will order again within seven days.	If students do not repeat, projected order frequency, contribution revenue and customer-acquisition payback fail.	Run a two-week pilot with 50 activated students across two outlets and expose all users to the same confirmed-pickup proposition.	Timestamped order records showing first and repeat purchases, cohort repeat rate, orders per user, cancellations and pickup waiting time.
#2: Food vendors will accept an approximately 10% commission while maintaining price parity and reliable menu updates.	Without sufficient commission and price parity, MessMate either lacks revenue or loses its student value advantage; without vendor participation, the marketplace has no supply.	Negotiate with at least three vendors, secure two written pilot commitments and run real transactions at the proposed commission for two weeks.	Written commercial terms, transaction settlements, menu-price comparisons, vendor margin feedback and continued participation after the pilot.
#3: Outlet-confirmed inventory and capped pickup slots can achieve at least 90% fulfilment with a median pickup wait below seven minutes.	Reliability is the core differentiation. Operational failure would recreate the same uncertainty and queues MessMate promises to remove.	Operate capped slots at two outlets during peak periods, audit inventory mismatches and compare promised versus actual ready and pickup times.	Timestamped preparation and pickup logs, fulfilment percentage, stock-out rate, median and 90th-percentile wait time, complaints and vendor workload observations.

17. Next Validation Actions

Assignment 1 Submission Notice

This Complete Venture Plan is ready to be submitted for Assignment 1 in the DGU Entrepreneurship & Innovation course portal.

Assignment 2 Software Capstone Transition

Proceed to Assignment 2: Build Your Venture App. Use your MVP specifications from Section 14 to build an individual working application prototype.

Venture Plan Final Review Confirmation

This consolidated plan was reviewed and finalised on 28 September 2026 at 07:40 pm.